

FINANCIAL INTELLIGENCE COMPLIANCE DIVISION

# SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTION REPORT (STR)

CONFIDENTIAL · REGULATORY SUBMISSION DRAFT

|                       |                                |                   |                                                                        |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Subject Customer ID:  | CUS-1015                       | Report Generated: | 2026-09-02 03:40:25 UTC                                                |
| Subject Name:         | Deepa Malhotra                 | Adjudication:     | ■ DRAFT REGULATOR-READY STR (High Risk / Suspicious Pattern Confirmed) |
| Regulatory Framework: | FIU-IND / FATF PMLA Guidelines | Filing Priority:  | High Priority Escalate                                                 |

## SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTION REPORT (STR)

### 1. REPORT METADATA

\*\*\*Subject ID:\*\* CUS-1015

\*\*\*Subject Name:\*\* Deepa Malhotra

\*\*\*Filing Classification:\*\* High Priority Suspicious Activity Filing

\*\*\*Core Typology:\*\* Layering & Pass-Throughs via Rapid In-and-Out / Foreign Commercial Conduit Activity

### 2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This Suspicious Transaction Report (STR) is submitted regarding anomalous, high-risk SWIFT activity observed on the retail account of Deepa Malhotra (CUS-1015). The filing is triggered by a sudden, unverified inbound foreign commercial SWIFT transfer of \$48,000.00 from a Dubai, UAE trading entity, followed immediately—within 4 hours and 45 minutes—by an outbound SWIFT transfer of \$22,000.00 to a trust vehicle in the Cayman Islands. The observed transactions bear no economic relationship to the subject's declared profile as a freelance graphic designer, exhibit high-velocity pass-through characteristics designed to sever audit trails across high-risk secrecy jurisdictions, and represent a 100% anomalous shift in account utilization.

### 3. SUBJECT & KYC CONTEXT

\*\*\*Declared Occupation:\*\* Graphic Designer (Freelance)

\*\*\*Declared Monthly Income:\*\* \$2,800.00 USD (\$33,600.00 USD/year)

\*\*\*Declared Account Purpose:\*\* Personal Savings & Freelance Operations

\*\*\*Observed Account Turnover:\*\* \$70,000.00 USD across 2 transactions within a 5-hour window.

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|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| + | -----                                                                        | + |
|   | INCOME VS. FLOW ANALYSIS                                                     |   |
| + | -----                                                                        | + |
|   | Stated Monthly Income: \$2,800.00 USD                                        |   |
|   | Single Inbound Transfer: \$48,000.00 USD (1,714% of Monthly Income)          |   |
|   | Stated Annual Income: \$33,600.00 USD                                        |   |
|   | Inbound vs. Annual Ratio: 143% of Total Annual Expectation in a Single SWIFT |   |
| + | -----                                                                        | + |

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\*\*\*Discrepancy & Entity Mismatch Analysis:\*\*

1. **\*\*Severe Financial Disproportionality:\*\*** The single inbound transaction (\$48,000.00) exceeds the subject's entire declared annual income expectation (\$33,600.00) by 43%, and represents over 17 times her expected monthly earnings.
2. **\*\*Structural Entity Mismatch:\*\*** The subject is a retail individual maintaining an account for freelance graphic design and personal savings. However, the account functioned as an intermediary conduit between a foreign commercial entity (**\*\*Al-Zahra Trading LLC\*\***, UAE) and an offshore financial trust (**\*\*Cayman Island Trust Ltd\*\***, Cayman Islands). There is no documented commercial rationale, trade relationship, or economic nexus connecting a freelance graphic designer to an offshore escrow agreement of this magnitude.
3. **\*\*Account Evolution & History:\*\*** The account maintained a clean 36-month historical precedent with low-value, routine personal activity. However, in the current active window, routine baseline activity dropped to **\*\*\$0.00 (0%)\*\***, while high-risk SWIFT pass-through activity comprised **\*\*100% (\$70,000.00 total movement)\*\***. This sudden structural shift indicates that the account has been compromised, sold, or recruited to serve as an international money mule/layering node.

### 4. CHRONOLOGY OF SUSPICIOUS TRANSACTIONS

| Transaction Date & Time   Direction / Type   Amount (USD)   Counterparty & Origin / Destination   Reference / Narrative   Flagged Suspicious Indicators                                                                                                                                     |  |  |  |  |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|--|--|
| :---   :---   :---   :---   :---   :---                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>**2026-03-02 09:15 EST**</b>   <b>**INBOUND**</b> / SWIFT   +\$48,000.00   <b>**Al-Zahra Trading LLC**</b> <br>(Dubai, UAE)*   Foreign Commercial Settlement   Sudden high-value commercial inflow; 1,714% of monthly income; high-risk international trade hub origin.                  |  |  |  |  |  |
| <b>**2026-03-02 14:00 EST**</b>   <b>**OUTBOUND**</b> / SWIFT   -\$22,000.00   <b>**Cayman Island Trust Ltd**</b> <br>(Cayman Islands)*   Escrow Deposit   Extreme velocity (executed <b>**4h 45m**</b> post-receipt); transfer into a primary secrecy jurisdiction; audit trail severance. |  |  |  |  |  |
| * <b>**Residual Account Balance Held:**</b> <b>**\$26,000.00 USD**</b> (retained in account post-dissipation).                                                                                                                                                                              |  |  |  |  |  |

### 5. TYPOLOGY & REGULATORY GUIDELINES ANALYSIS

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |  |
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| ##### A. Alignment with FATF Recommendations                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| * <b>**FATF Recommendation 10 (Customer Due Diligence):**</b> The transactions fail to align with the customer's verified profile, source of funds, and business activities. The financial institution was unable to establish a clear legal or economic purpose for the multi-jurisdictional transfers.                               |  |
| * <b>**FATF Recommendation 19 (Higher-Risk Countries):**</b> The flow routes capital through jurisdictions requiring enhanced scrutiny—specifically bridging a commercial trade hub in the Middle East ( <b>**UAE**</b> ) with a high-risk financial secrecy regime in the Caribbean ( <b>**Cayman Islands**</b> ).                    |  |
| * <b>**FATF Typologies on Money Laundering &amp; Terrorist Financing:**</b> Matches established indicators for <b>**Pass-Through / Conduit Accounts**</b> and <b>**Trade-Based Money Laundering (TBML) Intermediary Exploitation**</b> , where individual accounts are utilized to obfuscate UBO (Ultimate Beneficial Owner) tracking. |  |
| ##### B. Alignment with FIU-IND / Global FIU Guidance Notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |
| * <b>**Red Flag Indicator (RFI) – Rapid In-and-Out Activity:**</b> Inflow of high-value funds followed by immediate outbound transmission, leaving a partial balance, where the account operates as an active transit vehicle lacking commercial substance.                                                                            |  |
| * <b>**Audit Trail Severance:**</b> Vague transfer narratives ("escrow deposit") combined with destination trusts in non-cooperative or secrecy jurisdictions deliberately break the evidentiary link between the funding source and final disposition.                                                                                |  |
| ...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |  |
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |
| Al-Zahra Trading LLC                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |  |
| (Dubai, UAE)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |  |
| +-----+                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |  |

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| Inbound SWIFT: \$48,000.00  
v  
+-----+  
| SUBJECT: Deepa Malhotra |  
| (Retail Mule / Pass-Through) |  
| \*Retains \$26,000.00\* |  
+-----+  
|  
| Outbound SWIFT: \$22,000.00  
| (Lapse: 4 Hours 45 Minutes)  
v  
+-----+  
| Cayman Island Trust Ltd |  
| (Cayman Islands) |  
+-----+  
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### 6. FALSE-POSITIVE VS TRUE-POSITIVE EVALUATION

A comprehensive technical review was conducted to determine if this alert could be resolved as a false positive.  
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| FALSE-POSITIVE MITIGATING FACTORS | TRUE-POSITIVE AGGRAVATING FACTORS |  
+-----+  
| • Account operational for 36 months with | • Extreme Velocity: Outbound transfer executed in |  
| valid, completed KYC documentation. | < 5 hours (4h 45m), bypassing holding cycles. |  
| • Zero prior AML alerts or adverse media | • Severe Income Disproportionality: Inflow is |  
| records on file. | 1,714% of stated monthly earnings. |  
| | • Anomalous Ratio: 100% of current activity is |  
| | comprised of anomalous foreign transfers. |  
| | • Entity Mismatch: Personal account bridging a |  
| | commercial entity and an offshore secrecy trust. |  
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\*\*Technical Justification for True-Positive Determination:\*\*  
Despite the customer's clean 36-month historical baseline, this case **cannot** be closed as a false positive. The complete absence of routine personal transactions combined with a 100% anomalous transaction ratio (\$70,000.00 movement) confirms a radical operational shift. The extreme execution velocity (4.75 hours) demonstrates an intentional attempt to dissipate capital before automated anti-money laundering hold thresholds or manual compliance reviews could take effect. The presence of high-risk jurisdictions on both sides of the conduit confirms a **True Positive for Layering via Mule/Pass-Through Account**.

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### 7. COMPLIANCE OFFICER CONCLUSION & RECOMMENDED ACTIONS

\*\*Final Adjudication:\*\* **CONFIRMED TRUE POSITIVE**  
**Quantified Risk Score:** 88 / 100 **Confidence Level:** **HIGH**

**\*\*Official Compliance Decision:\*\*** `DECISION: DRAFT\_STR\_FOR\_REGULATOR`

#### Recommended Escalation & Operational Actions:

- 1. **\*\*Immediate Regulatory Filing:\*\*** Transmit this official Suspicious Transaction Report (STR / SAR) to the relevant Financial Intelligence Unit (FIU-IND / FinCEN) in accordance with statutory reporting mandates.
- 2. **\*\*Operational Account Freeze:\*\*** Maintain an immediate administrative hold on the remaining **\*\*\$26,000.00 USD\*\*** balance in the account to prevent further asset dissipation.
- 3. **\*\*Formal Request for Information (RFI):\*\*** Issue an urgent RFI to subject Deepa Malhotra demanding:
  - \* Underlying commercial contracts, invoices, or service agreements with Al-Zahra Trading LLC.
  - \* Executed escrow agreements and legal documentation supporting the transfer to Cayman Island Trust Ltd.
  - \* Tax documentation justifying the uncharacteristic foreign earnings.
- 4. **\*\*Account Status Revision:\*\*** Place the subject on the institutional High-Risk / Blacklist Watchlist and initiate account closure procedures upon completion of regulatory review periods.
- 5. **\*\*Law Enforcement Escalation:\*\*** Prepare a law enforcement referral package for specialized financial crime/anti-money laundering units regarding potential international mule network operations.

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**\*\*REPORT FILED BY:\*\*** Senior Regulatory Compliance Officer

**\*\*DATE OF SUBMISSION:\*\*** March 2, 2026

**\*\*STATUS:\*\* SUBMITTED / PENDING FIU ACKNOWLEDGMENT**

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**LEGAL & REGULATORY NOTICE:** This Suspicious Transaction Report contains confidential compliance analysis. Unauthorized dissemination is strictly prohibited under applicable Anti-Money Laundering legislation.